

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Building blocks of a cultural region

LANGUAGE -> communication and literary core with a hearth and a spread

RELIGION -> sacred sites, ritual calendars, group identity and landscapes

TRIBE AND ETHNICITY -> historical communities associated with a habitat

LIVELIHOOD AND MIGRATION -> the cultural landscape of work; diffusion and mixing

STATE POLICY -> linguistic states, schedules, autonomy arrangements and reservation

MUST REMEMBER: Cultural and social geography examines language, religion, caste, tribe, ethnicity, gender, livelihood, landscape, place identity and diffusion across India's plural regions; cultural area, hearth, route, frontier, sacred landscape and vernacular region are analytical tools rather than fixed natural containers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Region types compared

FORMAL -> a dominant shared trait such as language or religion defines the area

FUNCTIONAL -> interaction through pilgrimage, market or media ties the area together

VERNACULAR -> a named, imagined region such as the Hindi belt, Deccan or North-East

OVERLAP -> functional circuits routinely cut across formal boundaries

EXAM USE -> name the type first, then argue about the boundary

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Hearth to identity sequence

CULTURAL HEARTH -> the source area where the trait originates

DIFFUSION -> spread along routes, rivers, markets and migration corridors

OVERLAP ZONE -> two traditions coexist and interact in the same space

MIXED BORDERLAND -> bilingual belts, syncretic practice and shared calendars

NEW REGIONAL IDENTITY -> the margin produces its own recognised character

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Distribution and density firewall

DISTRIBUTION -> the spatial arrangement of people; answers the where question

DENSITY -> a ratio of people to area; answers the how concentrated question

ARITHMETIC -> total population over total area; misleads where land is uninhabitable

PHYSIOLOGICAL -> population over cultivable area; exposes hidden land pressure

AGRICULTURAL -> farming population over cultivable area; isolates agrarian pressure

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Controls on population distribution

RELIEF AND SOIL -> level land and deep renewable alluvium permit intensive settlement

WATER -> rainfall, perennial rivers and shallow groundwater set cropping intensity

CLIMATE -> growing-season length and reliability deter or permit occupation

HISTORY -> valleys carrying millennia of settlement, urbanism and state formation

ECONOMY AND CONNECTIVITY -> industry, ports, irrigated commands, rail and canal networks

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Ganga basin convergence

LEVEL EXTENSIVE ALLUVIAL PLAIN -> almost the whole surface is cultivable and traversable

DEEP RENEWABLE ALLUVIUM -> khadar tracts are renewed by annual deposition

PERENNIAL SNOW-FED RIVERS -> assured water unlike seasonal peninsular rivers

SHALLOW PRODUCTIVE AQUIFERS -> tube-well irrigation permits multiple cropping

HISTORY AND TRANSPORT -> inherited settlement plus dense networks on level ground

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Basin internal variation

WEST TO EAST -> density rises from the drier west toward the wetter middle and lower basin

NORTHERN FRINGE -> tarai constraints differ sharply from the central plain

LOWER AND DELTAIC BASIN -> very high rural density with flood and erosion exposure

URBAN-INDUSTRIAL NODES -> density peaks that agriculture does not explain

RULE -> never write the basin as an internally uniform region

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Density consequence chain

HIGH PHYSIOLOGICAL DENSITY -> holdings become small and continue fragmenting

SMALL HOLDINGS -> investable surplus and mechanisation capacity fall

LAND PRESSURE -> groundwater over-abstraction and out-migration follow

FLOODPLAIN SETTLEMENT -> exposure rises because the active surface is occupied

NATIONAL LINK -> the same fertility makes the region critical to foodgrain supply

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Micro-relief belt sequence

BHABAR -> coarse gravel and boulder wash where streams disappear underground

TERAI -> marshy belt where those streams re-emerge; productive once drained

BHANGAR -> older alluvial upland above the flood limit, often with kankar nodules

KHADAR -> newer alluvium of the active floodplain, most fertile and most flood-exposed

ACTIVE CHANNEL BELT -> levees, bars, ox-bow lakes and char or diara lands

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Two gradients and five sub-regions

GRADIENT ONE -> rainfall rises from the north-west toward the humid east

GRADIENT TWO -> the micro-relief transect repeats away from the mountain front

WESTERN AND CENTRAL PLAIN -> irrigated cereals with drawdown; dense fragmented holdings

EASTERN PLAIN -> water-rich yet productivity-constrained by gradient and drainage

BRAHMAPUTRA AND DELTA -> braided erosion insecurity; tidal salinity and cyclone exposure

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Scheduled Tribe, tribe, indigenous and ethnic group are not automatic synonyms; language family differs from script and official status, caste distribution from caste determinism, cultural region from state boundary, and diversity from either frictionless harmony or permanent conflict.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Cultural marker geographies

LANGUAGE -> regional cores, transition zones and relief-sustained minority pockets

RELIGION -> concentrations plus pilgrimage circuits forming functional interaction regions

TRIBE -> forested hill, plateau and north-eastern association from historical isolation

LIVELIHOOD -> agrarian structures and urban occupational clustering link to economy

MIGRATION -> corridor communities in destination cities redistribute culture continuously

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Indo-Aryan/Dravidian/Austroasiatic/Tibeto-Burman language zones, tribal central belt and Northeast, Himalayan and coastal livelihoods, pilgrimage networks, pastoral routes, borderlands and metropolitan mosaics require named maps; Census 2011 remains the completed census baseline while identities are dynamic and multi-scalar.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Data discipline and the policy-mapping anchor

CENSUS RULE -> the last completed all-India Census is the baseline for any figure

SURVEY RULE -> a newer figure must carry a named survey and its date

FORBIDDEN -> density, growth, literacy, sex ratio, speaker and share figures from memory

9 JULY 2024 -> Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list of vulnerable tribal groups

READING -> identity and habitat remain geographically organised for present policy